The Betterfly Way

BETTERFLY

The Betterfly Way

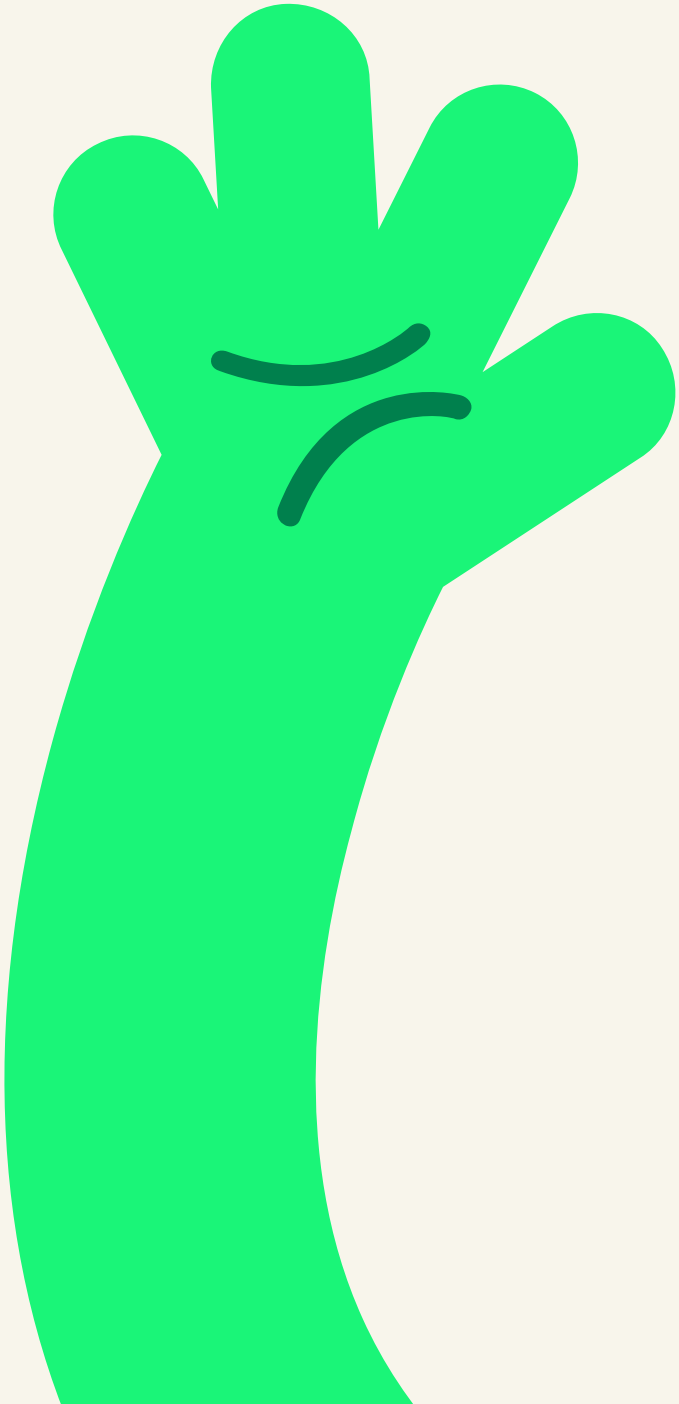
A Pocket Guide for Building our
Product Experience

Why Are You Reading This?

As we step into what might be our most exciting chapter yet, this pocket guide serves as a North Star to ensure all teams are working towards the same vision. It's here to help us understand not just what we're building, but why.

These principles will help us:

- Make aligned decisions across functions
- Stay true to our core beliefs as we accelerate Product Market fit and scale
- Communicate with a consistent voice
- Design experiences and content that deliver on our clients' and users' needs



A Letter from our Founder

When I started Betterfly, I was driven by a simple yet powerful vision: **to empower people to live their best lives**. This vision has been our North Star throughout our journey, guiding every step we've taken.

Looking back, our path now makes perfect sense–from pioneering healthy habits, to connecting those habits with life insurance for longevity, to finally integrating health insurance to ensure not just longer lives, but better ones. With each step, the picture became clearer.

Now, the final piece has clicked into place: a healthcare approach that doesn't wait for people to get sick before helping them. We've arrived at a crucial turning point: **reimagining healthcare from the ground up**.

Traditional health insurance pays after you're sick; and life insurance pays after you die. **We've flipped the script: our health insurance keeps you thriving, and our life insurance helps you live longer**. This isn't just evolution—it's a revolution, transforming insurance from a safety net into your active partner in health.

By combining the security of comprehensive medical coverage with our approach to holistic health, we're uniquely positioned to help people address root causes, optimize their vitality, and unlock their full potential through everyday habits and functional interventions.

In the pages that follow, we will share our vision for how Betterfly will bridge the gap between traditional medicine and the future of health in a way no one else has.

What makes our vision truly powerful is our approach to partnering with employers, enabling us to democratize proactive healthcare and reach millions who previously lacked access to preventive tools. Together, we can deliver what people truly crave: a life of energy, purpose, and resilience.

We're thrilled you're here with us on this journey. **This is our moment to fundamentally redefine how healthcare is experienced**—from reactive to proactive, from treating illness to optimizing human potential. Imagine a world where millions wake up energized, driven by purpose, and confident they're protected every step of the way. Your contribution is essential to turning this vision into reality.

Together, we're not just building a company—we're changing what healthcare means.

We stand at the threshold of a global transformation in how people approach their health – making Betterfly not just a business opportunity, but a once-in-a-generation chance to redefine what's possible for human wellbeing.

Let's do it.

Eduardo della Maggiora
Founder & CEO

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The Big Picture

From our Burn to Give days to the thousands of lives we've impacted, what a journey it's been.

We've experimented with different business models, revenue streams, and product features. We've tested, failed, succeeded, and grown wiser. Through it all, rapid iteration and bold experimentation have become our DNA.

But here's the beautiful constant - our mission has never changed: to empower people to live their best lives.

We do this through an engaging, integrated platform that transforms how organizations support their people and how individuals take ownership of their health journey.

Why We Exist

Bridging The Gap Between Reactive and Proactive Care

Betterfly was born from a simple belief: that encouraging healthy habits, protecting people's wellbeing, and creating positive impact transforms lives.

Our journey began by transforming life insurance—rewarding healthy habits instead of just covering risk. But as we grew, we saw a bigger problem: healthcare has always followed the same broken formula—wait until people get sick, then try to fix them.

Today, we're building a new model.

One that doesn't wait. One that empowers people every day. Moving from life insurance to lifelong health.

Doubling down on prevention while maintaining our commitment to protection and purpose, creating a paradigm that gives people agency long before they enter the traditional healthcare system.

Instead of focusing solely on treatment-based care—hospitals, medications, and doctor visits that activate after illness—Betterfly's model integrates and amplifies prevention-first care. Through tools, guidance, and personalized support, we help people stay healthy before problems start.

Betterfly empowers individuals to build better habits and take control of their health, while ensuring access to traditional care when it's needed. But we go further—showing users how to unlock the full value of their existing insurance. We guide them to proactively request tests, screenings, and services that are already covered—but often overlooked.

This approach shifts health from something you deal with when you're sick, to something you own every day. With Betterfly, insurance becomes a catalyst for wellness, not just a safety net. This dual transformation—of systems and behaviors—is what sets Betterfly apart.

Why Users Stay

Making Health Accessible, Simple and Rewarding

Here's the truth: our users don't wake up thinking about disrupting insurance or the healthcare system (though they certainly feel the frustration when interacting with them).

They engage with Betterfly because we make health accessible, simple and rewarding. Through a combination of coverage, personalized guidance, and rewards, we help them build better lives - one small step at a time.

At the heart of this engagement is understanding what drives behavior.

People are motivated by more than just personal rewards—they're energized by a sense of progress, friendly competition, and the chance to make a difference beyond themselves. These insights shape how we design every touchpoint, creating a system that not only protects but inspires.

How to answer the big question:

What is Betterfly?

The Elevator Pitch

We're the first platform that transforms traditional health insurance into a proactive wellness tool, helping people take control of their health every day, not just when they're sick.

The 30-Second Answer

Betterfly is a health platform that reimagines insurance as a holistic system. Unlike traditional plans that step in only when illness strikes, our model supports your entire health journey.

By combining comprehensive coverage with personalized prevention tools, Betterfly empowers people to build healthy habits, access essential care, and unlock the full value of their insurance—cultivating energy, resilience, purpose, and vitality every day.

Picture your health as a tree

What if we didn't treat our health as a checklist,
but as a living system?
From habits to coverage, every part matters.

The Branches are like Traditional Medicine

Your safety net: outpatient care, telemedicine, pharmacy care, hospital care, voluntary benefits, and life insurance. It steps in when things go wrong and it's the backbone of what we offer our clients.

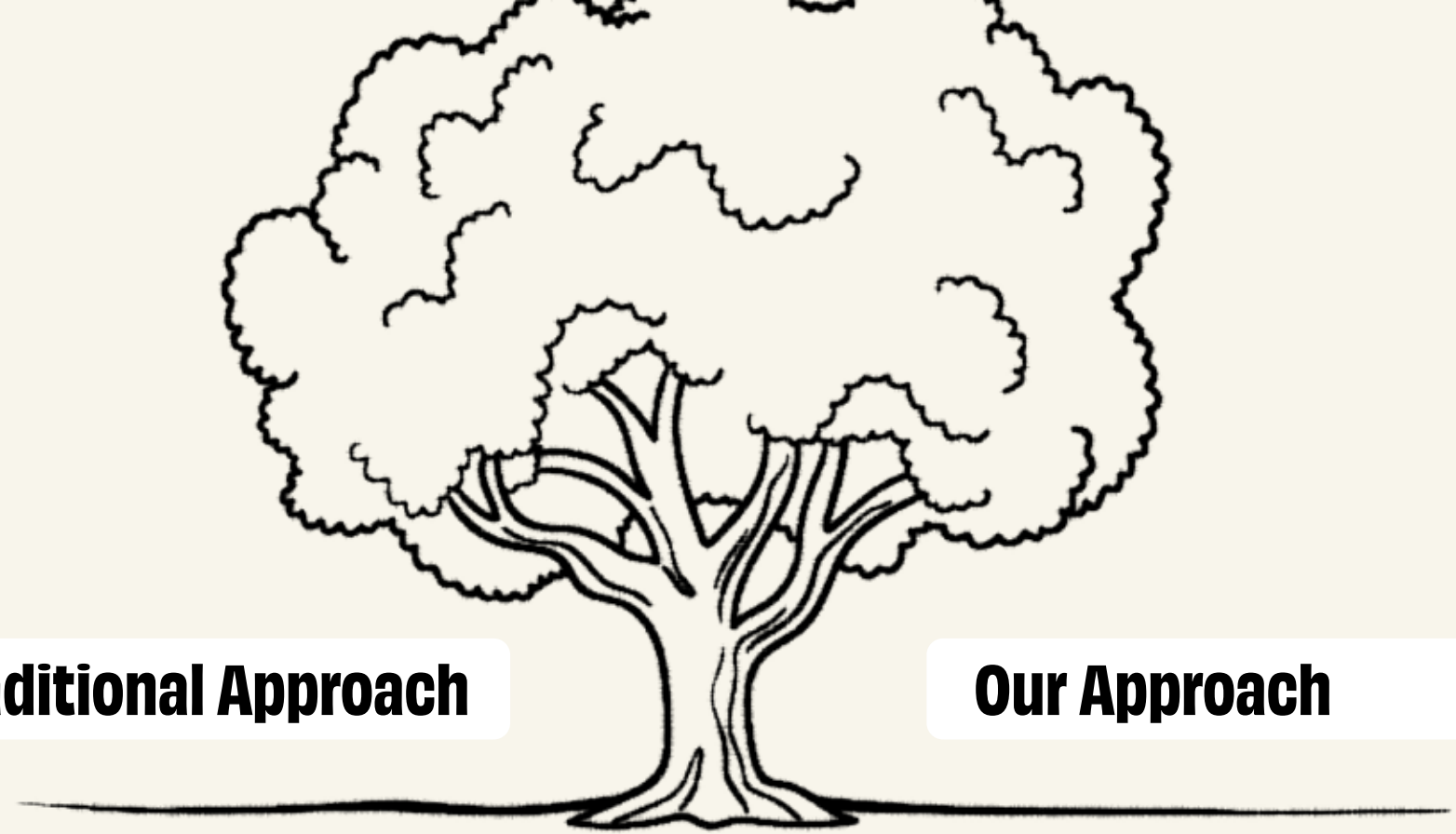
The Soil is like Lifestyle Medicine

These are the daily habits that keep you strong: sleep, exercise, nutrition, mindset, community and purpose. They provide the nutrients for resilience and is at the heart of our brand experience.

Roots are like Functional Medicine

These support your internal systems: heart health, brain health, immune health, gut health, metabolic health and cellular health. They are the foundation of long-term vitality and integrating this into our platform is a key differentiator for Betterfly.

Betterfly strengthens the branches, enriches the soil, and nurtures the roots—so you don't just survive illness, you thrive in health.



Traditional Approach

- Trims branches after damage
- Treats symptoms, not causes
- Reactive rather than preventive

Our Approach

- Strengthen branches with expert care
- Enriches soil with healthy habits
- Nourishes roots with personalized insights and guidance

Different Audiences, Different Messages, Same North Star

We're B2B2C. Let's unpack what that really means.

While our app is built for individuals – their personal growth, their health journey, their access to insurance and health tools – we reach these people through their employers. This creates an interesting dynamic: we're telling the Betterfly story to two very different audiences.

First, there's the business side

Employers want to streamline costs and save time. Not exactly inspiring, but it's reality – and we respect that. They also deeply care about engaging and retaining their teams.

Our vision is that over time, we'll increasingly partner with companies who share our mission of building healthier, happier workforces (and yes, we already have some dream partners!) You'll notice our B2B messaging highlights the functional benefits of our platform.

We're working to bridge this gap while respecting what drives purchasing decisions.

Then there's our end users

For them, Betterfly might start as "just another company benefit" – something they didn't ask for. But this blank slate is our biggest opportunity. What sets us apart is our promise: we're here to make lives meaningfully better.

Through an experience that incentivizes healthy habits, provides personalized insurance benefits, and turns personal progress into social impact.

That's huge.

What this means for our teams

Product creates a unified, AI-powered healthcare platform where insurance and wellness work together to make prevention engaging and rewarding. We transform abstract health goals into clear, achievable steps on each user's personal roadmap.

Design crafts beautiful, intuitive experiences that make progress visible and meaningful. We make every interaction feel like a step forward on the user's journey to better health and greater protection.

Communication guides and encourages users through their personal roadmap. Through our Product Marketing team, we communicate directly with employees and employers, working alongside Client Success to support admins. Meanwhile, our Social, Web, and Content teams ensure consistent messaging across all touchpoints. We speak with one clear voice, making complex insurance concepts feel approachable and prevention feel achievable. We are educators, empowering users with the knowledge they need to make informed health improvements and get the most from their benefits.

Client Success builds strong relationships with administrators, ensuring they maximize platform value while supporting their employees' wellbeing journey. Working closely with our Communication teams, they provide admins with the tools and insights needed to drive engagement and results.

Sales leads with conviction - we're not just offering health insurance, we're enabling a new approach to employee wellbeing. We show how Betterfly transforms traditional benefits into measurable health improvements, higher engagement, and long-term value.

A note on Buddy

This guide wouldn't be complete without a nod to Buddy.

While building our platform, we recognized that AI could revolutionize the experience, but a faceless chatbot wouldn't capture hearts or trust. So we created Buddy - a personalized health companion with personality, expertise, and genuine helpfulness.

For employees, Buddy breaks down complex insurance terms, celebrates progress, and offers tailored advice when needed. In future state, Buddy will be equipped with the knowledge to tell users exactly how they can maximize their insurance and benefits. For employers, Buddy provides actionable insights, simplifies benefits management, and helps teams maximize health investments.

Behind the friendly interface, Buddy is constantly learning. We've trained Buddy not just to answer questions, but to understand context, anticipate needs, and create truly personalized experiences.

Buddy embodies our core belief: health should be accessible, engaging, and personal. Think of Buddy as the thread that connects the Betterfly experience, ensuring no one walks their health journey alone.

First sketch, 2023

Today's Buddy (Phew)

Core Truths:
Our Guiding Principles

These aren't just nice ideas – they're fundamental to how we build our product and serve our users. When in doubt, refer back to these six.

1. A Journey Worth Taking
2. Take the Stairs, Not the Elevator
3. Little Steps Lead to Big Changes
4. Obsession Beats Talent
5. Focus on the Root
6. The Ripple Effect

A Journey Worth Taking

Not everyone who gets access to Betterfly is ready for change. We design for both the ready and the hesitant, the enthusiastic and the skeptical. We don't force transformation; we inspire it. Because while every journey starts differently, what matters is making each step that follows meaningful and worthwhile.

First Steps Should Feel Easy

Change is hard enough. Our job is to remove barriers, not create them. Every moment of friction becomes another reason not to start. So, keep it simple. Keep it inviting.

How we do this:

Clear the Path to Starting

- Make onboarding intuitive and frictionless
- Create clear, obvious paths to getting started by eliminating unnecessary steps and complexity
- Design for immediate value, not information overload

Meet People Where They Are

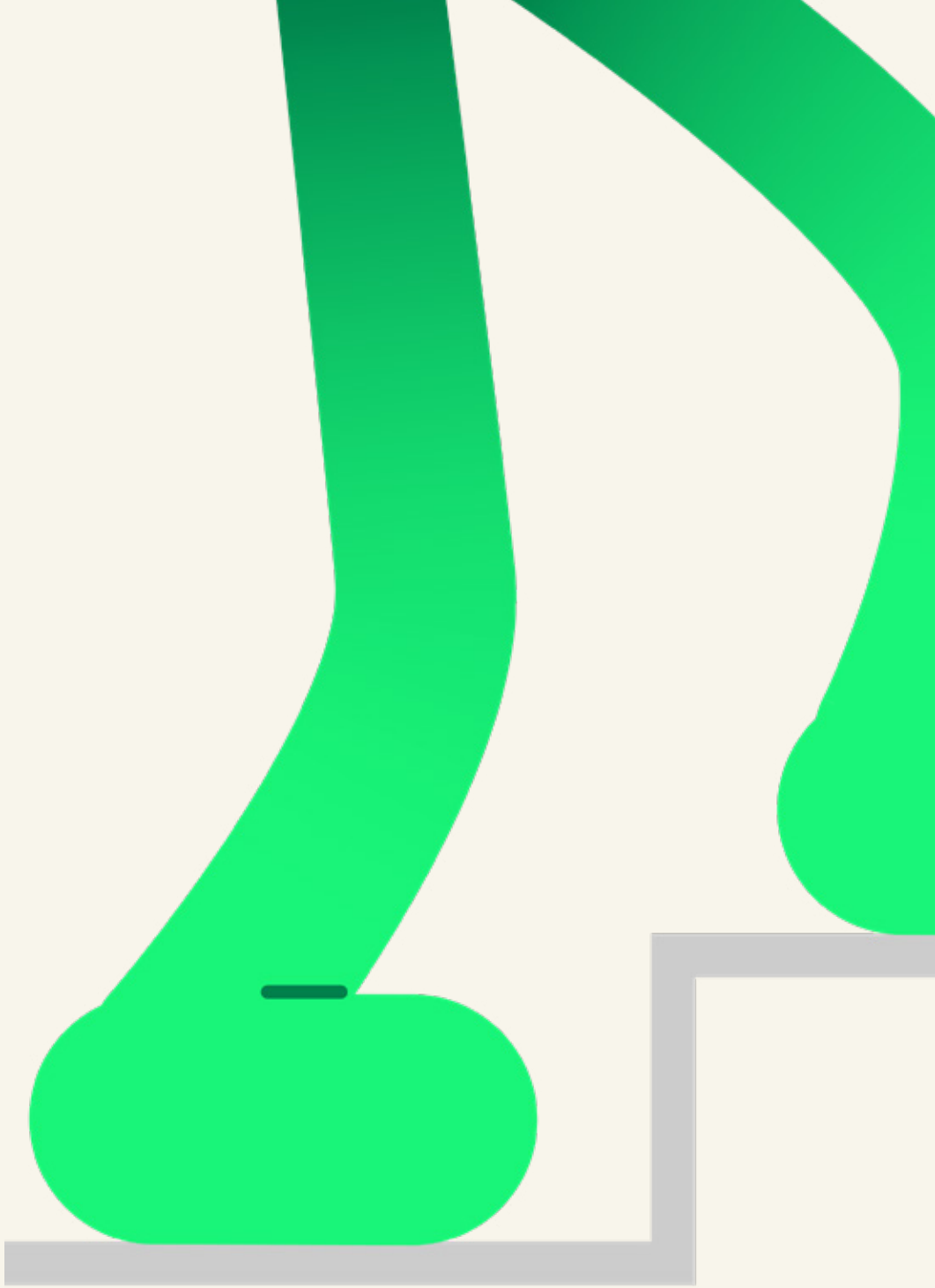
- Position ourselves as supportive partners with a welcoming tone, not as experts talking down
- Celebrate any step forward, no matter how small
- Acknowledge that change isn't linear – setbacks are normal
- Use Buddy to provide supportive, personalized guidance

Make Every Touch Point Count

- Ensure notifications feel helpful, not intrusive
- Make in-app content discoverable and relevant
- Create moments of unexpected delight
- Provide value before asking for commitment
- Show – don't just tell – how daily actions grow protection

Take the Stairs, Not the Elevator

In other words, we avoid shortcuts. This truth runs deep. In product development, we must resist the temptation of quick fixes because we know they lead to technical debt and poor user experience. For our users, we must be equally honest: lasting change in wellness doesn't come from fad diets or 7-day challenges. Real progress takes time, and we're here for the long haul.



Design for the Journey

Change that lasts comes step by step. Our job isn't to remove the effort – it's to make it rewarding. Let's focus on designing experiences that celebrate the journey, not just the destination.

How we do this:

Make Progress Feel Rewarding

- Create flows that visualize progress and celebrate milestones
- Build features that support sustainable habits, not quick fixes
- Show the value of consistent, small efforts

Inspire Without Taking Over

- Balance intrinsic motivation with external rewards
- Design notifications that guide rather than nag
- Let users and employers own their achievements
- Create moments of pride, not just prizes

Give Context to Every Action

- Teach the 'why' behind healthy habits
- Balance education with action
- Help users connect daily actions to long-term goals

Little Steps Lead to Big Changes

If there's one truth that defines both our product philosophy and our user experience, it's this: meaningful change happens gradually. We believe anyone can transform their life through small, consistent actions. Every feature we build, every notification we send, every milestone we celebrate reinforces this belief. It's not about dramatic transformations – it's about sustainable progress.

Build Momentum, Not Pressure

Sustainable change comes from positive momentum, not pressure. We're building a journey users want to continue, not one they feel they have to.

How we do this:

Make Every Small Win Feel Big

- Celebrate progress, no matter how small
- Create natural rhythms of engagement, not demanding streaks
- Welcome users back without judgment
- Focus on progress over perfection

Turn Dreams into Doable Steps

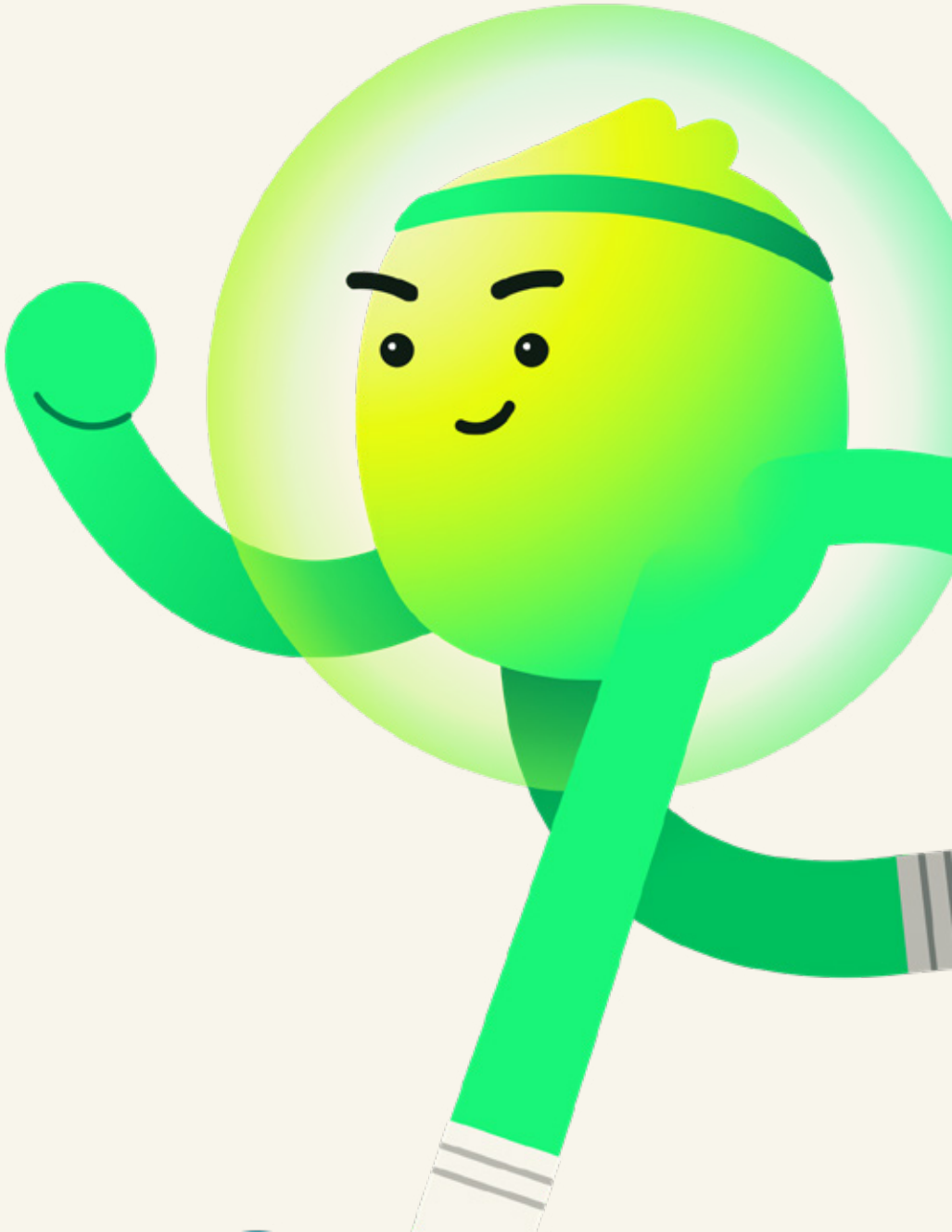
- Break big ambitions into manageable steps
- Guide users to what they're ready for next
- Transform abstract goals into concrete actions
- Make progress visible and meaningful

Build Success into the System

- Design features that support gradual progression
- Build feedback loops that reinforce positive momentum
- Measure success through consistent engagement
- Consider the growth journey in every feature

Obsession Beats Talent

Natural ability only gets you so far. What matters most is relentless dedication to improvement - that applies to building product and better habits. We believe the most powerful force for change isn't innate talent – it's sustained focus and genuine care. This shapes how we approach product development (constant iteration, attention to detail) and how we support our users (celebrating consistency over intensity, commitment over capability).



Celebrate Dedication

Consistency builds what talent alone cannot. We're designing for users who maintain steady progress, not just those who excel occasionally.

How we do this:

Reward Commitment

- Design streak mechanics that celebrate regular, manageable efforts
- Build milestones that honor habit building
- Focus metrics on retention and habit formation

Make Progress Undeniable

- Visualize the compound effect of consistency
- Create reflection moments that showcase commitment
- Design feedback that acknowledges effort, not just outcomes
- Help users see how far they've come

Focus on the Root

Too many healthcare solutions treat the symptoms without addressing what lies beneath. We take a different approach. Whether it's stress, poor health, or financial instability, we believe in going deeper. Our product is built to help users understand and address the root causes of their challenges, not just put a band-aid on the problem. This means sometimes taking the longer, harder road – but it's the only way to create lasting change.

Build Foundations, Not Quick Fixes

Preventing problems beats fixing them.
True health means understanding and addressing root causes, not just treating symptoms.

How we do this:

Connect the Deeper Dots

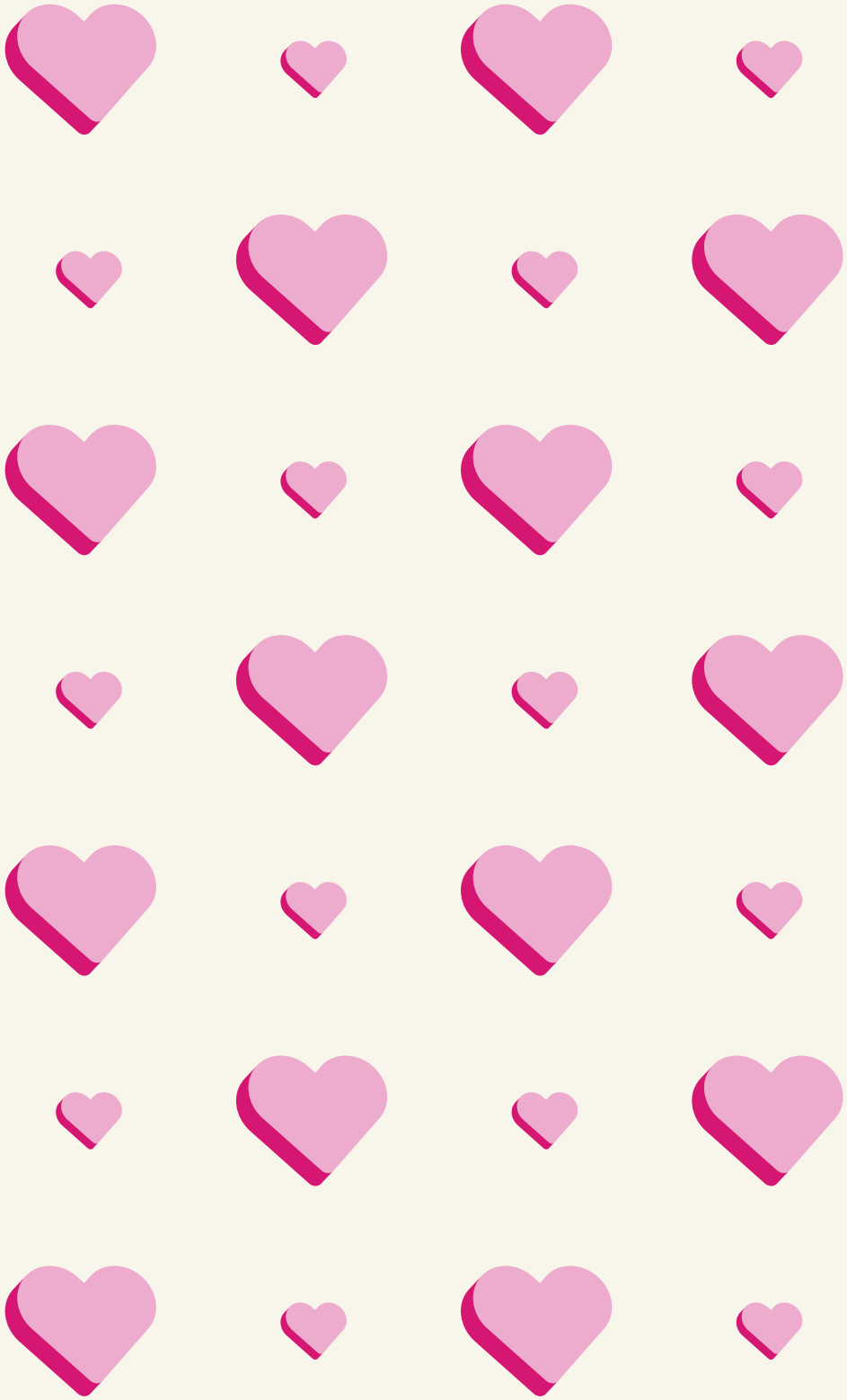
- Guide users to understand their behavior patterns
- Show connections between different areas of wellbeing
- Design for holistic health, not isolated metrics
- Help users see the bigger picture

Build Strong Foundations

- Create educational content that builds fundamental health understanding
- Help users recognize connections between behaviors and outcomes
- Guide informed choices through evidence-based information
- Design experiences that transform awareness into action
- Measure meaningful indicators of true health, not just surface metrics

The Ripple Effect

Personal wellbeing isn't just personal.
When someone improves their health, their entire sphere of influence benefits – their family, their workplace, their community. This ripple effect is built into our product through features like charitable donations tied to healthy actions. One person's wellness journey can create waves of positive change.



Design Beyond the Individual

We design features that turn “me” into “we.” Interactions should create opportunities for users to see how their personal journey contributes to something bigger, making the ripple effect tangible and motivating.

How we do this:

Individual Actions Matter

- Create features that connect personal actions to wider impact
- Make charitable giving mechanics transparent and meaningful
- Build visualizations showing collective progress
- Include stories demonstrating how wellness creates positive change
- Consider how each feature amplifies beyond the user

Connect Personal and Collective Progress

- Create moments of recognition when users benefit others
- Design engagement loops with social reinforcement
- Build team and company challenges showing group impact
- Visualize both personal metrics and collective significance
- Help users see their journey as part of something larger

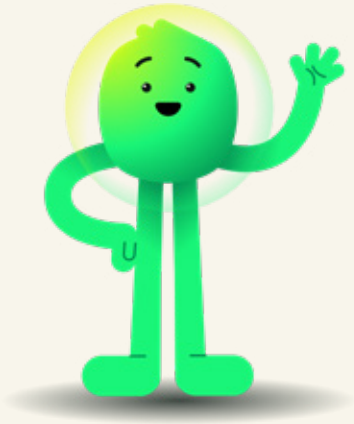
Before You Go

This pocket guide isn't meant to gather digital dust. Keep it close, refer to it often, and let it challenge your thinking. When in doubt about a decision, feature, or message - come back to these principles.

Remember: we're not just building another app. We're creating a new way for people to understand their health, grow their protection, and improve their lives.

So go build something meaningful. Make it intuitive, make it worthwhile, and above all, make it count.

Our users are waiting.



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